

2. Social work

Social workers who dedicate their time to agencies servicing families in low-income or high-risk geographical areas may see total forgiveness of their Perkins Loan. An increasing amount of debt will be forgiven for each of



five years served in these areas. Licensed clinical social workers will see the most money forgiven through public service (including government and nonprofit agencies). (Visit SocialWorkers.org for more information.)

3. Volunteering

Popular programs such as the Peace Corps, AmeriCorps, and Volunteers in Service to America (VISTA—which is now part of AmeriCorps) all offer deferment or partial payment toward loan debt. Each program differs in its formula for awarding payments. Participants may see up

to 70% of select government loans forgiven. (While not technically considered a paying “job,” a stipend is usually offered in the compensation package for these programs.)

4. Military

The Montgomery G.I. Bill, offered through the change to U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs, may pay up to 60% of college tuition costs. Those active in the Army National Guard may be eligible for a payment of up to \$10,000 toward loan debt. Additionally, many veterans and private military associations offer funding through scholarships and grants.

5. Child care

Many child-care providers are eligible for up to 100% of outstanding loan debt. To qualify, they must have received a degree in early childhood education. Their services must be used by a community of low-income families for one complete school year or two half-years. (Note: The Federal Perkins Loan Program stopped taking applications for new participants in 2017. If you have received benefits in the past, however, you may still be eligible. See the program details at StudentAid.ed.gov.)